

1 User interface

3ds Max is an extremely useful software tool for all major types of 3D modelling, animation, special effects, and graphics rendering in the areas of graphics intensive video gaming, special effects and CGI in feature films. 3ds Max is a power house of features that can help you with most graphics projects and generate incredibly realistic or highly stylised three dimensional graphics. But then again, the humongous number of features and options available in 3ds Max might seem very daunting for most newcomers. But because of this very same problem, the software is built very consistently and the interface is made as intuitive as possible. Once you start trying out new things and experimenting with the interface, you can keep moving into new areas and get a hang of things. Only then will you be able to experience the real power of 3D in Max.

1.1 The interface: your playground

The first step in getting familiar and working with 3ds Max is getting a hang of the interface, the different menus available and how to make proper use of them. If you're trying your hand at 3ds Max for the first time, you should spend some time viewing the videos in the 'New Features and Essential Skills Movies' section. You'll find this in the menu while the program is launched, and will give you a basic idea of the software. Once you've gone familiar with the menu, simply uncheck the 'Show this Dialog at startup' option at the bottom left of the window.

Most of the components in the 3ds Max interface are similar to the ones you'll commonly find in Windows. On the other hand, there are a few counter intuitive components that are specific to 3ds Max. Therefore it is good to first get a proper understanding of how things are organised. 3ds Max has a plethora of tools and options; in fact, there are so many of them that it'd get overwhelming.



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